

Hi teacher, here's everything you need to know about our policy reforms

We are improving our system so teachers can:

- teach with more focus and less interruption
- design better learning experiences
- use assessment to guide learning—not just give grades
- adapt teaching to real conditions
- support every learner, in every situation

These are not separate changes. They work together as one system to improve learning.



Three-Term School Calendar

Three grading periods in the year
Focused teaching w/ Instructional Blocks
Dedicated time for activities, grades computation, remediation



Assessment, Grading, & Awards

More formative assessment during lessons
KS1 moving to descriptive grades
KS2-4 taking out transmutation
Focus on feedback and actions



Lesson Planning

One simplified lesson plan format: *Intentions, Learning Experiences, Assessment, Ways Forward*
Guided by clear learning design principles



Education in Emergencies (EiE)

Clear response levels for schools: *Hayo, Hlnay, Hinga, Hinto*
Schools can decide response level based on safety, capacity, and wellbeing



Flexible Learning Program (FLP)

Structured support for learners with barriers
Harmonized school readiness, application, and monitoring processes



Strengthened Senior High School (SHS)

Simplified structure: 5 core subjects and 2 tracks
Students choose electives
Better preparation for college, work, or life



Work Immersion, Field Exposure, & Arts Apprenticeship

Longer time (up to 640 hours) for work immersion
Stronger connection to careers and skills

Teachers' Checklist

Here's a step-by-step guide to ensure teachers are prepared for this coming school year.

Task	Completed	Notes
Phase 1: Learner Profiling & Assessment Baselines		
Gather Beginning-of-School-Year (BOSY) Data: Collect results from the CRLA and RMA to spot gaps in foundational skills.		
Data: Identify At-Risk Learners: Tag learners who may need FLP supports (e.g. students with health conditions, working learners, or those in remote areas).		
Capability Mapping: Record each learner's access to devices and connectivity to strengthen emergency planning in school.		
Phase 2: Instructional Planning & Learning Design		
Review the Three-Term Budget of Work (BoW): Align your sequence of competencies with the recommended weeks in the BoW.		
Draft your Initial Lesson Plans: Use the new, flexible template that prioritizes Learning Design Principles and embeds formative assessment.		
Prepare Alternative Resources: Identify and ready print or digital resources in case classes move to a Hinay (Ease-in) or Hinga (check-in) level due to emergencies.		
Plan for KS1 Assessment Centers: Design Integrated Performance Tasks and rubrics instead of paper-and-pencil tests for Kinder and KS1.		
Categorize AI Use in Tasks: Declare whether AI use is <i>Prohibited</i> , <i>Limited</i> , or <i>Extensive</i> for each formative assessment.		
Design Integrative Performance Tasks: Create at least one Integrative PT that produces a single output assessed across multiple learning areas to ease learner workload.		

Task	Completed	Notes
Phase 3: Grading & Promotion Readiness		
Prepare for Adjusted Transmutation: Apply the transitional grading table for KS2-KS4 for SY 2026-2027, where a raw grade of 70.00 converts to 75.		
Set Grading Weights (Key Stages 2-4): Configure class records to follow the 20% Written Works (WW), 50% Performance Tasks (PT), and 30% ST-TE weighted system.		
Set Up PACE Forms (KS1): Implement the Performance and Competency Evaluation (PACE) Form to progressively record qualitative evidence instead of one-time entries.		
Plan for Remediation (ARAL): Mark Week 5 (after the first Summative Test) as the start date for targeted remedial interventions for at-risk learners.		
Review Academic Excellence Criteria: Note that candidates for awards must have a General Average of 95+ with no final grade below 85 in any learning area.		
Phase 4: Emergency & Continuity Preparedness		
Establish an Emergency Call Tree: Build a communication chain to safety-check every learner within 12 hours of a disruption.		
Pre-position Emergency Kits: Prepare identified learning resources (like learning packets) ready for distribution when needed.		
Update the LSCP: Finalize the Learning and Service Continuity Plan (LSCP) before the Opening Block and orient parents on the continuity levels.		
Phase 5: Professional Capacity Building		
Participate in LAC Sessions: Engage in peer-to-peer sessions to calibrate rubrics, share effective formative strategies, and exchange lesson design ideas..		
Collaborative Lesson Planning: Work with grade-level teams to streamline instructional preparation and share digital resources.		
Trauma-Informed Training: Complete Psychological First Aid (PFA) training and trauma-informed teaching to support learners during the Hinga (Check-in) or Hinto (Stop) levels of emergency.		

Starting Strong

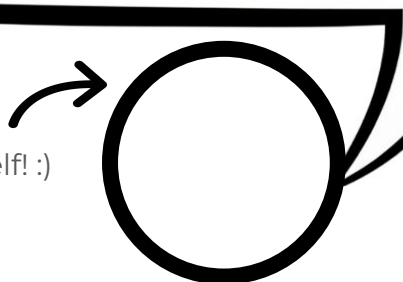
Once the school year officially begins, reflect on these things and make actionable decisions so you can start the school year strong.

Complete this sentence:

From the very beginning of the school year, I want my learners to feel/think...

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Draw yourself! :)



Now that my goals for learners are clear, what preparations can I do to reach these goals?

Classroom Culture: How can I co-create classroom norms with my learners?

Establishing Routine: How will I introduce routines in a way that feels engaging and memorable?

Socio-emotional Well-being Checks:
How will I build trust and a sense of belonging in the first weeks?

Parent Orientation: What key messages do I want parents to take away?

Learning Continuity: In case of emergencies, what resources and modalities are accessible to my learners?

What other things should I prepare for?

Learning Design Principles

These principles are evidence-based practices for effective teaching—across grade levels and learning areas. Use these as references while designing lessons. Here's a mnemonic: CL-A-S-S-P-I-C-S, so we can visualize good teaching in a class



Clear Goals and Teaching

Show and Tell. Don't just list the goal; explain the "key idea" and model the process using concrete examples

Did I use accessible language and anticipate where learners might get confused?



Active Retrieval and Spacing

Connect the dots. Plan short reviews of past lessons to connect prior knowledge to today's new topics and competencies

How am I helping learners remember and build mastery over time?



Self-awareness and Metacognition

Set the compass. Embed time for learners to set their own goals, monitor their progress, and reflect on how they are learning

Are learners practicing habits that lead to independent learning? Are they learning to learn?



Scaffolding

I Do, We Do, You Do. Provide worked examples and guides first, then gradually release responsibility so learners can try on their own

Am I giving them enough support to build fluency before asking for independent work?



Purpose & Values Integration

Find the 'Why'. Connect the lesson to the learners' community, personal values, real-world contexts, or socio-emotional skills

Does this lesson feel personally meaningful to the learner's life?



Inclusion

Design for all. Provide multiple ways for learners to see the information, act on it, and express what they know

Have I balanced "desirable difficulties" with the supports to remove learning barriers?



Checks for Understanding

Check early and often. Conduct quick, low-stakes formative checks during the lesson flow, not just at the end

If learners are confused, am I ready to rephrase or provide a new example immediately?



Social Learning

Structure the talk. Use group work and discussions to help learners see different perspectives and build a sense of belonging

Are the ways for learners to learn with and from one another?

Need ideas for building lessons? Use the pedagogy cards here: bit.ly/BLDCards, which you can use as strategies that you can use and integrate into your lessons